



CODECHEF

The CodeChef.com Challenge, your monthly dose of coding puzzles from India's biggest coding contest, is now in print!

*H*ello and welcome to the CodeChef Puzzle Challenge sponsored by *LINUX For You* and Direct! We're back after a short hiatus and this time we're bigger and better than ever! Now, let's see how many of you can solve this month's puzzle to become one of the three lucky winners to bag some awesome prizes, both in cash and merchandise!

The May edition's puzzle

A rich merchant who had collected a lot of gold coins, did not want anybody to know about them. One day, his wife asked him, "How many gold coins do we have?" After pausing a moment, he replied, "Well! If I divide the coins into two unequal numbers, then 32 times the difference between the two numbers equals the difference between the squares of the two numbers."

The wife looked puzzled. Can you help the merchant's wife by finding out how many gold coins they have?

The solution

The rich merchant has 32 gold coins.

How did we do it?

First, divide the rich merchant's coins into two unequal

numbers, x and y .

Let us assume that $x > y$.

On reading the problem carefully we see that $32(x-y) = x^2 - y^2$

Since $x^2 - y^2$ can be split up into $(x+y)$ and $(x-y)$, $x-y$ on both sides of the $=$ sign cancel each other out and we are left with the equation $x+y = 32$ which is our answer.

And the winners this month are:

- Manu Konchady
- Pramod Kukhshal
- Sonali Majumdar

Your Codechef Puzzle Of The Month

A frog is at the bottom of a 30 metre well. Each day he summons enough energy for a 3 metre leap, up the well. Exhausted, he then hangs in there for the rest of the day. At night, while he is asleep, he slips 2 metres backwards. How many days will it take him to escape from the well?

Note: Assume that after the first leap his hind legs are exactly three metres up the well. His hind legs must clear the well for him to escape.

Looking for exciting prizes?

Solve this month's CodeChef Challenge puzzle and send in your answer by the 15th of June, 2011, to codechef@efyindia.com. You can also post your answer to the puzzle online at <http://www.linuxforu.com/codechef/>. Three lucky winners will get exciting prizes both in cash and merchandise!

About CodeChef: CodeChef.com is India's first, non-commercial, online programming competition, featuring monthly contests in more than 35 different programming languages. Log on to CodeChef.com for the June Challenge that takes place from the 1st to the 11th of June, 2011, to win cash prizes of up to Rs 20,000. But that's not all. Stay tuned to CodeChef and participate in the multiple programming contests that take place on the website throughout the month!